Northstar Labs Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Policy

Version 1.0 – Internal Policy Document

Northstar Labs is committed to maintaining resilient business operations and minimising service disruption in the event of system failures, cyber incidents, infrastructure outages, or other operational disruptions. This policy defines the organisation's approach to business continuity planning, disaster recovery preparedness, backup management, recovery objectives, and service restoration procedures.

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1. Backup Management

Northstar Labs performs regular backups of critical business systems, production databases, configuration files, and operational data. Backups are encrypted both in transit and at rest and are stored within approved cloud environments located within the United Kingdom and European Economic Area (EEA). Backup schedules are monitored automatically and backup failures are investigated promptly. Backup retention periods are aligned with operational, contractual, and regulatory requirements.

2. Recovery Objectives (RTO/RPO)

The organisation maintains defined recovery objectives for critical systems and services. Recovery Time Objective (RTO): Critical customer-facing systems should be restored within 4 hours of a confirmed major incident. Recovery Point Objective (RPO): Critical production data loss should not exceed 1 hour where technically feasible. Recovery objectives are reviewed periodically based on business requirements, infrastructure changes, and customer commitments.

3. Availability Expectations

Northstar Labs aims to maintain high availability for customer-facing systems and critical internal services. Production infrastructure is designed using resilient cloud-native architecture principles, including redundancy, monitoring, automated alerting, and scalable infrastructure components. Planned maintenance activities are communicated in advance where possible to minimise operational disruption. Service availability metrics are monitored continuously by the engineering team.

4. Disaster Recovery Testing

Disaster recovery procedures and backup restoration processes are tested periodically to validate operational readiness and recovery effectiveness. Testing activities may include: • Backup restoration validation • Infrastructure failover testing • Incident simulation exercises • Recovery walkthroughs • Tabletop exercises Test outcomes, identified risks, and improvement actions must be documented and tracked appropriately.

5. Failover Process

Critical systems are designed to support failover capabilities where operationally appropriate. In the event of a major outage or infrastructure failure, authorised engineering personnel may initiate failover procedures to restore service availability. Failover activities may involve: • Switching to secondary cloud infrastructure • Restoring systems from backup • Redirecting traffic to redundant services • Deploying infrastructure using automated recovery procedures All failover and recovery activities must be logged and reviewed following service restoration.